The Rite of the Single-Syllable Mantra of Noble Mañjuśrī

Āryamañjuśrīmantraikākṣarakalpa · Toh 896 · Derge Kangyur
འཕགས་པ་འཇམ་དཔལ་གྱི་སྙིགས་ཡི་གེ་འབྲུ་གཅིག་པའི་ཆོ་ག

The Rite of the Single-Syllable Mantra of Noble Mañjuśrī, known in Tibetan as 'Phags pa 'jam dpal gyi sngags yi ge 'bru gcig pa'i cho ga, is a brief ritual text centered on a one-syllable mantra of Mañjuśrī, the bodhisattva of wisdom. It opens by praising the mantra as supremely secret, as the heart essence of all the Tathāgatas, and as able to accomplish every aim and fulfill every hope. It then gives a series of practical applications in which the mantra is recited over simple substances such as a tooth stick, rock salt, or old ghee to relieve toothache, cure eye disease, draw out weapon fragments lodged in the body, and ease ailments such as indigestion. The work is Toh 896 in the Kangyur, where it belongs among the short tantric ritual and dhāraṇī texts devoted to mantra practice for healing and protection.

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tadyathā oṃkṣṇī

This secret mantra of a single syllable is supremely secret. It accomplishes every aim and performs every action. It is the heart essence of all the Tathāgatas, and it completely fulfills every hope.

If one recites it over a tooth stick and then holds it, toothache is removed.

For painful eyes, one should grind rock salt, recite the mantra over it seven times, and fill the eyes with it, and the eye disease will be cleared away.

When a fragment of a weapon remains inside a person's body, one should recite the mantra seven times or one hundred and eight times over old ghee, and then have the person drink it or smear it on the opening of the wound, and the fragment of the weapon will come out.

For indigestion, for bloating and distension, and for diarrhea caused by fever, one should recite the mantra seven times over black salt, or rock salt, or any other kind of salt, and eat it. One will then be freed from that illness and will recover that very day.

For pain in the head, one should recite the mantra seven times over a crow's feather and stroke the head with it, and that illness will be healed.

This completes the dhāraṇī of the single syllable of Mañjuśrī.

Translator's Notes

• The salt called murang is a specific medicinal salt, taken here as black salt (Skt. sauvarcala). The verb in the headache remedy is read as "stroke" or "brush" with the feather. The compound rendered "bloating and distension" is not certain in its exact medical sense. In the toothache remedy the Tibetan says only that one "holds" the tooth stick. It does not say where.

Colophon

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Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.